



2026

History & Geography

Grade 5 · Paper 1 of 4

Theme: Dutch Colonisation of Mauritius & Districts of Mauritius

Time allowed: **1 hour** Total marks: **50**

Name: _____

Class: _____ Date: _____

Instructions to Candidates

1. Write your name, class and date in the spaces above.
2. Answer **all** questions in all three sections.
3. For tick-box questions, place a clear tick (✓) in the box next to your chosen answer.
4. Write your answers neatly in the spaces provided. Do not write outside the answer boxes.
5. The marks available for each question are shown in the box on the right.
6. Read each question carefully before you answer.

Mark allocation: Section A — History (25 marks) | Section B — Geography (15 marks) | Section C — Civics (10 marks)

Section A — History of Mauritius [25 marks]

1 For each question below, tick (✓) ONE correct answer.

(a) Which nationality of Europeans first *sighted* the island of Mauritius, around 1507?

1

- ☐ Dutch
- ☐ Portuguese
- ☐ French
- ☐ British

(b) In which year did the Dutch first *land* on Mauritius?

1

- ☐ 1507
- ☐ 1598
- ☐ 1638
- ☐ 1715

(c) After whom did the Dutch name the island 'Mauritius'?

1

- ☐ King William of Holland
- ☐ Admiral Wybrandt van Warwijck
- ☐ Prince Maurice of Nassau
- ☐ Governor Cornelis Simonsz

(d) The Dutch finally abandoned Mauritius in which year?

1

- ☐ 1658
- ☐ 1681
- ☐ 1710
- ☐ 1715

2 Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

5

"When the Dutch sailors first landed in Mauritius in 1598, they found the island completely uninhabited by humans. Dense ebony forests covered much of the land, and strange flightless birds called dodos walked the ground without any fear of man. The Dutch East India Company (VOC) established the first permanent colony in 1638 under Governor Cornelis Simonsz. Settlers cut down enormous quantities of ebony wood to ship back to Europe. They also introduced deer and pigs to the island. However, the colony faced constant hardships — powerful cyclones destroyed their crops, plagues of rats consumed their food stores, and outbreaks of disease weakened the

settlers. By 1710, the remaining Dutch colonists abandoned Mauritius for good."

- (a) According to the passage, what type of wood did the Dutch cut down and ship to Europe?

[1 mark]

- (b) Name TWO hardships the Dutch colony faced, as mentioned in the passage.

[2 marks]

- (c) The passage says the dodo "walked the ground without any fear of man." What does this suggest about why the dodo became easy to hunt? What happened to the dodo after human settlement?

[2 marks]

- 3 Describe THREE effects of Dutch colonisation on Mauritius. Write about two or three sentences for each effect.**

6

Award 2 marks per effect.

(a) Effect 1:

(b) Effect 2:

(c) Effect 3:

- 4 Answer the following short questions about the Dutch period.**

5

(a) What does the abbreviation **VOC** stand for (in English)? [1 mark]

(b) Give TWO reasons why the Dutch abandoned Mauritius in 1710. [2 marks]

- (c) The dodo bird is now extinct. Name ONE action by the Dutch that contributed to its disappearance. [1 mark]

- (d) Name the nationality of Europeans who *took over* Mauritius after the Dutch left. [1 mark]

- 5 Explain how the arrival of Europeans changed the island of Mauritius forever. In your answer, refer to at least TWO specific changes — these may be environmental, animal, or social changes. 5

Section B — Geography of Mauritius [15 marks]

6 Tick (✓) **ONE** correct answer for each question.

(a) How many districts does the main island of Mauritius have?

1

☐ 7

☐ 8

☐ 9

☐ 10

(b) In which district is the famous Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam National Botanical Garden located?

1

☐ Moka

☐ Pamplemousses

☐ Flacq

☐ Savanne

(c) Which district contains *Piton de la Petite Rivière Noire*, the highest mountain in Mauritius?

1

☐ Grand Port

☐ Savanne

☐ Black River

☐ Moka

7 Draw a line to match each district to its correct description.

6

District

Black River

Grand Port

Pamplemousses

Flacq

Port Louis

Savanne

Description

Located in the south of Mauritius

Capital city of Mauritius is here

Home of the famous Botanical Garden

Site of an important naval battle in 1810

Contains the highest mountain peak

Has many sugar cane fields on the east coast

8 Answer the following questions about the districts of Mauritius.

6

(a) List any **FOUR** districts of Mauritius. [2 marks — ½ mark each]

- (b) Name the **capital city** of Mauritius. In which district is it found? [2 marks]

- (c) Explain the difference between a *district* and a *village* in Mauritius. Give ONE example of each. [2 marks]

Section C — Civics & National Identity [10 marks]

9 Tick (✓) **ONE** correct answer for each question.

(a) How many colours are on the national flag of Mauritius?

1

☐ 2

☐ 3

☐ 4

☐ 5

(b) What does the **blue** stripe on the Mauritian flag represent?

1

☐ The sky over Mauritius

☐ The Indian Ocean surrounding Mauritius

☐ The rivers of Mauritius

☐ The unity of the people

(c) What is the **national bird** of Mauritius?

1

☐ Flamingo

☐ Echo Parakeet

☐ Dodo

☐ Mauritius Kestrel

(d) On which date is the National Day of Mauritius celebrated each year?

1

☐ 1 January

☐ 12 March

☐ 1 May

☐ 12 August

10 Answer the following questions about national identity in Mauritius.

6

(a) Name **TWO** national symbols of Mauritius. For each one, describe what it represents. [4 marks]

Symbol 1:

Symbol 2:

- (b) Mauritius has many different cultural communities. Name TWO communities and state ONE festival or celebration that each community observes. [2 marks]



Mark Scheme — Paper 1 (Dutch Colonisation & Districts)

For teacher / parent use only. This mark scheme is a guide. Accept any answer that is factually correct and demonstrates understanding. Where the question asks for a named example, accept any valid example. Full marks may be awarded for concise correct answers; explanations earn the second mark.

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
1(a)	Portuguese	1
1(b)	1598	1
1(c)	Prince Maurice of Nassau	1
1(d)	1710	1
2(a)	Ebony (wood)	1
2(b)	Any TWO from: powerful cyclones / plagues of rats / disease / crops destroyed. (1 mark each)	2
2(c)	The dodo had no instinct to fear or flee from humans (1 mark), so it was very easy to catch and kill / sailors hunted them; it became extinct / died out (1 mark).	2
3(a–c)	Any THREE from: forests of ebony were cut down (deforestation); dodo and other wildlife driven to extinction; deer and pigs introduced (changed the ecosystem); sugarcane and agriculture introduced; rats and other vermin introduced; the island remained uninhabited by humans for most of the Dutch period. Award 2 marks per well-explained effect, 1 mark for a bare statement.	6
4(a)	Dutch East India Company (Vereenigde Oostindische Compagnie)	1
4(b)	Any TWO from: cyclones; plagues of rats; disease/famine; failed crops; difficulty governing the colony; attacks by escaped slaves. (1 mark each)	2
4(c)	Any ONE: hunting by Dutch settlers / sailors; rats ate their eggs; destruction of forests removed their habitat; pigs ate their nests.	1
4(d)	French	1
5	Award 2 marks for each clearly explained change (up to 4 marks), plus 1 mark for overall clarity/coherence. Changes may include: extinction of the dodo; deforestation of ebony; introduction of new animals; no people lived there before Europeans; later colonisation by other powers. Partial credit for bare mentions without explanation.	5
6(a)	9	1
6(b)	Pamplemousses	1
6(c)	Black River	1

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
7	Black River → Contains the highest mountain peak; Grand Port → Site of naval battle 1810; Pamplemousses → Botanical Garden; Flacq → East coast sugar cane; Port Louis → Capital city; Savanne → South of Mauritius. (1 mark each)	6
8(a)	Any four from: Black River, Flacq, Grand Port, Moka, Pamplemousses, Plaines Wilhems, Port Louis, Rivière du Rempart, Savanne. (½ mark each)	2
8(b)	Port Louis; Port Louis district. (1 mark each)	2
8(c)	A district is a large administrative area of the country (1 mark); a village is a smaller community/settlement within a district (1 mark). Accept any valid examples, e.g. district: Flacq; village: Centre de Flacq.	2
9(a)	4	1
9(b)	The Indian Ocean surrounding Mauritius	1
9(c)	Dodo	1
9(d)	12 March	1
10(a)	Any two national symbols with explanation. Examples: Flag — represents the nation / its four colours represent independence, the ocean, light, and agriculture; Dodo — national bird, symbol of Mauritius's unique wildlife; Coat of Arms — national emblem; National flower (Trochetia boutoniana). Award 2 marks per symbol (1 for naming, 1 for what it represents).	4
10(b)	Any two communities with a festival for each. Examples: Hindu community — Diwali / Holi / Maha Shivaratri; Muslim community — Eid ul-Fitr / Eid ul-Adha; Chinese community — Chinese New Year; Creole community — Creole Day / Kermesse; Christian community — Christmas / Easter. (1 mark per community + festival pair)	2
Total		50